



INGLÉS 2

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MODULE B

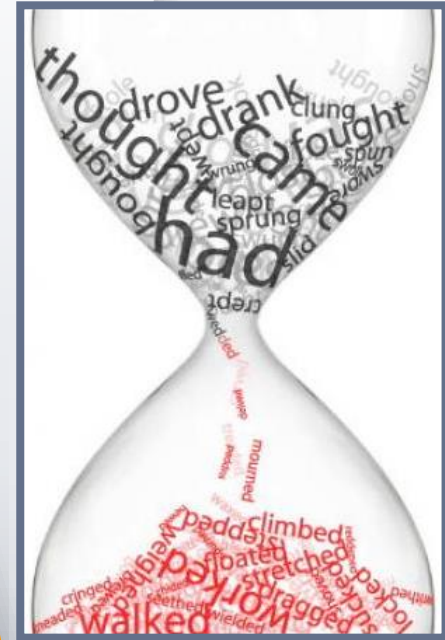
UNIT B1

Self-study Preview

Past Continuous Tense:

- ✓ <https://www.britishcouncil.org.mx/blog/past-continuous> (Section: Grammar).
- ✓ <https://english.lingolia.com/es/gramatica/tiempos-verbales/past-progressive> (Section: Grammar).

PAST SIMPLE TENSE (review)





❖ The simple past tense refers to:

- ✓ an action which occurred at a specific time in the past:

I **ate** a salad for lunch today.

He **worked** all day yesterday.

- ✓ a completed action:

She finally **mailed** the letter.

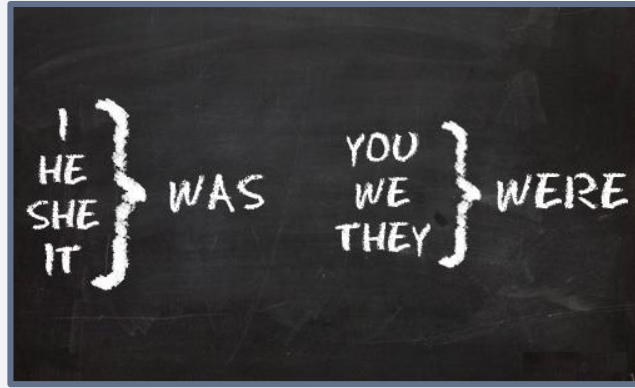
Marie **finished** her report on time.

- ✓ past state:

Jane **was** a movie star.

I **was** a very good student at high school.

Verb “To Be”



I was born in Villa María.

She was a doctor in the USA.

He was in Africa last summer.

It was cold yesterday.

We were at home last night.

They were my friends when I was a child.

You were right!

You were at my class last Thursday!

WAS - WERE TO BE - Past Tense

AFFIRMATIVE

I **was** happy.
He **was** hungry.
She **was** a nurse.
It **was** big.

We **were** early.
You **were** at school.
They **were** quiet.

NEGATIVE

I **wasn't** sad.
He **wasn't** thirsty.
She **wasn't** a teacher.
It **wasn't** small.

We **weren't** late.
You **weren't** at home.
They **weren't** noisy.

**wasn't =
was not**

**weren't =
were not**

QUESTIONS

+ Affirmative

They **were** happy.

She **was** rich.

? Question

Were they happy?

Was she rich?

Short Answer

Yes, they were / No, they weren't

Yes, she was / No, she wasn't

WH- Word

Where

Why

When

Verb

was

were

Subject

I / he / she / it

we / you / they

Complement

sick ...?

tired ...?

ready ...?

- **Why was** he angry?

- **Where were** you yesterday?

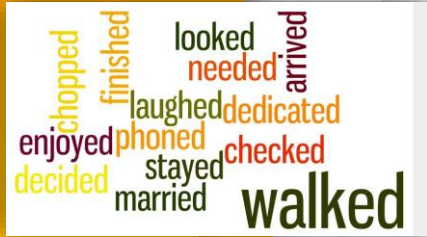
- **When was** she nervous?

- **Who were** those people?

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Past Simple: regular verbs

- ❖ Most verbs in English have a regular form in their past, that is, they only add “-**ed**” or “-**d**” to the base form of the verb.



I **arrived** late to the conference yesterday.

My brother **lived** in Spain for three years.

When she was young, she **danced** very well.

IMPORTANT

Statements	Questions	Negatives		Short Answers
		Full form	Short form	
I walked	Did I walk?	I did not walk	I didn't walk	Yes, I did
You walked	Did you walk?	You did not walk	You didn't walk	Yes, he did
He walked	Did he walk?	He did not walk	She didn't walk	Yes, we did
She walked	Did she walk?	She did not walk	He didn't walk	
It walked	Did it walk?	It did not walk	It didn't walk	No, you didn't
We walked	Did we walk?	We did not walk	We didn't walk	No, she didn't
You walked	Did you walk?	You did not walk	You didn't walk	No, they didn't
They walked	Did they walk?	They did not walk	They didn't walk	

Spelling Rules

- Verbs ending in **-e** add **-d** e.g. *live - lived*
- Verbs ending in consonant + vowel - consonant, double the consonant e.g. *stop - stopped*
- Verbs ending in consonant + **y**, drop **-y** and take **-ied** e.g. *tidy - tidied* BUT *play - played*

IMPORTANT

Pronunciation of ED

The pronunciation of words ending in ED depends on the final consonant (sound). There are three ways to pronounce ED:

/id/

T wanted
D needed

Voiced Sound
= uses the vocal
cords and they
produce a vibration
or humming sound
in the throat.

(Touch your throat to feel it)

/t/

P helped
K looked
SH washed
CH watched
GH laughed
TH breathed
SS kissed
C danced
X fixed

VOICELESS

/d/

L called
N cleaned
R offered
G damaged
V loved
S used
W followed
Y enjoyed
Z amazed

VOICED

Past Simple: irregular verbs

- There are also some verbs called irregular verbs that have special past tense forms:

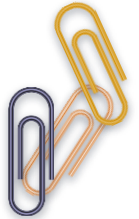


break	break	break
feed	fed	fed
fight	fought	fought
find	found	found
get	got	got
hang	hung	hung
have	had	had
hear	heard	heard
hold	held	held
keep	kept	kept
lay	laid	laid
lead	led	led
leave	left	left
lend	lent	lent
light	lit	lit
lose	lost	lost
make	made	made
mean	meant	meant
meet	met	met
pay	paid	paid
say	said	said

We **went** (go) to University yesterday.

The children **read** (read) that story last year.

The students **forgot** (forget) to do the project.



IMPORTANT

AFFIRMATIVE	QUESTIONS	NEGATIVES	SHORT ANSWERS
I went	Did I go...?	I did not (didn't) go	Yes, I did. Yes, he / she / it did. Yes, we / you / they did.
You went	Did you go...?	You did not (didn't) go	
He went	Did he go...?	He did not (didn't) go	
She went	Did she go...?	She did not (didn't) go	
It went	Did it go...?	It did not (didn't) go	No, I didn't. No, he / she / it didn't. No, we / you / they didn't.
We went	Did we go...?	We did not (didn't) go	
You went	Did you go...?	You did not (didn't) go	
They went	Did they go...?	They did not (didn't) go	

IRREGULAR VERBS

infinitive to ...	past simple	past participle have/has ...	infinitive to ...	past simple	past participle have/has ...	infinitive to ...	past simple	past participle have/has ...
be	was/were	been	grow	grew	grown	set	set	set
beat	beat	beaten	hang	hung	hung	sew	sewed	sewn/sewed
become	became	become	have	had	had	shake	shook	shaken
begin	began	begun	hear	heard	heard	shine	shone	shone
bite	bit	bitten	hide	hid	hidden	shoot	shot	shot
blow	blew	blown	hit	hit	hit	show	showed	shown/showed
break	broke	broken	hold	held	held	shrink	shrank	shrunk
bring	brought	brought	hurt	hurt	hurt	shut	shut	shut
build	built	built	keep	kept	kept	sing	sang	sung
buy	bought	bought	know	knew	known	sink	sank	sunk
catch	caught	caught	lay	laid	laid	sit	sat	sat
choose	chose	chosen	lead	led	led	sleep	slept	slept
come	came	come	leave	left	left	smell	smelt	smelt
cost	cost	cost	lend	lent	lent	speak	spoke	spoken
cut	cut	cut	let	let	let	spend	spent	spent
do	did	done	lie	lay	lain	spread	spread	spread
draw	drew	drawn	light	lit	lit	stand	stood	stood
dream	dreamt (-ed)	dreamt (-ed)	lose	lost	lost	steal	stole	stolen
drink	drank	drunk	make	made	made	stick	stuck	stuck
drive	drove	driven	mean	meant	meant	strike	struck	struck
eat	ate	eaten	meet	met	met	swim	swam	swum
fail	fell	fallen	pay	paid	paid	swing	swung	swung
feed	fed	fed	put	put	put	take	took	taken
feel	felt	felt	read	read [red]*	read [red]*	teach	taught	taught
fight	fought	fought	ride	rode	ridden	tear	tore	torn
find	found	found	ring	rang	rung	tell	told	told
fly	flew	flown	rise	rose	risen	think	thought	thought
forget	forgot	forgotten	run	ran	run	throw	threw	thrown
forgive	forgave	forgiven	say	said	said	understand	understood	understood
freeze	froze	frozen	see	saw	seen	wake	woke	woken
get	got	got	seek	sought	sought	wear	wore	worn
give	gave	given	sell	sold	sold	win	won	won
go	went	gone	send	sent	sent	write	wrote	written



Past Continuous

USE 1

Continuous action in the past
interrupted by a specific time.

- ❑ We use the **Past Continuous Tense** to talk about an action that was taking place at a particular time in the past:

She **was riding** her bike yesterday at 2 p.m.

They **were playing** table tennis at 10 last night.

I **was listening** to music yesterday morning.

IMPORTANT

A SPECIFIC TIME

**Simple Past = shows when
an action began or finished.**

Last night at 6 PM, I **ate** dinner.
(*I started eating at 6 PM.*)

**Past Continuous = only
interrupts the action.**

Last night at 6 PM, I **was eating** dinner.
(*I started earlier; and at 6 PM, I was in the
process of eating dinner.*)

USE 2

Continuous action in the past
interrupted by a past action.

- We can also use the **Past Continuous** and the **Simple Past** in the same sentence. We do this when we want to express that a shorter activity took place during a longer activity in the past:

Lara **was jumping** over the vaulting horse when she **hurt** herself.

- Notice the position of “**when**” and the use of the comma (,):

When I arrived home, they were watching TV.

She was peeling an apple **when** she cut herself.

- 
- ◆ Notice the difference in meaning between these two sentences:

When the students **came** to the class, the teacher **was leaving**.

When the students **came** to the class, the teacher **left**.

- In the first sentence, the teacher started to leave when the students arrived, the action of leaving was in progress when the other action happened (one sentence is in the Past Continuous and the other in the Simple Past).
- In the second sentence, the students arrived and then the teacher left, one action happened after the other (both sentences are in the Simple Past).



USE 3

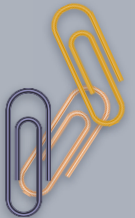
Parallel actions.

- When you use the Past Continuous with two actions in the same sentence, it expresses the idea that both actions were happening at the same time. The actions are parallel:

I **was cooking** and my sister **was cleaning** the house.

We **were watching** TV while they **were talking** very loudly.

While Ellen **was reading**, Tim **was watching** television.



USE 4

Creating atmosphere.

- In English, we often use a series of parallel actions to describe and create the atmosphere at a particular time in the past:

When I walked into the office, several people **were** busily **typing**, some **were talking** on the phones, the boss **was yelling** directions, and customers **were waiting** to be helped. One customer **was yelling** at a secretary and **waving** his hands. Others **were complaining** to each other about the bad service.

USE 5

Irritating continuous action in the past.

- ❑ The Past Continuous with words such as "always" or "constantly" expresses the idea that something irritating or shocking often happened in the past. Remember to put the words "always" or "constantly" between "be" and "verb + -ing”:

She **was always coming** to class late.

He **was constantly talking**. He annoyed everyone.

I didn't like them because they **were always complaining**.





PAST CONTINUOUS

POSITIVE

SUBJECT	+	WAS/WERE	+	PRESENT PARTICIPLE
I / He / She / It	+	was	+	playing
You / We / They	+	were	+	eating

Positive examples:

I was playing football. • She was eating chocolate. • They were fighting.

NEGATIVE

SUBJECT	+	WAS/WERE NOT	+	PRESENT PARTICIPLE
I / He / She / It	+	was not	+	playing
You / We / They	+	were not	+	eating

Contractions: wasn't / weren't

Negative examples:

I wasn't running. • He was not helping. • We weren't feeling very well.

QUESTIONS

WAS/WERE	+	SUBJECT	+	PRESENT PARTICIPLE ?
Was	+	I / he / she / it	+	playing?
Were	+	you / we / they	+	eating?

Questions examples:

Were you drinking my milk? • What were they doing? • Was it raining?

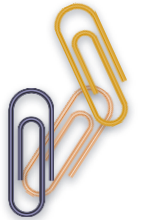


While vs. When

When you talk about things in the past, "**when**" is most often followed by the verb tense **Simple Past**, whereas "**while**" is usually followed by **Past Continuous**. "While" expresses the idea of “during that time”.

I was studying **when** she called.

While I was studying, she called.





Past Continuous and Past Simple:

- <http://www.englishpage.com/verbpage/verbs3.htm> (Section: Exercise).
- <http://www.englishpage.com/verbpage/verbs4.htm> (Section: Exercise).
- https://www.englisch-hilfen.de/en/exercises/tenses/simple_past_progressive.htm (Section: Exercise).
- https://www.englisch-hilfen.de/en/exercises/tenses/past_progressive_statements.htm (Section: Exercise).
- https://www.englisch-hilfen.de/en/exercises/questions/past_progressive.htm (Section: Exercise).
- https://www.englisch-hilfen.de/en/exercises/tenses/past_progressive_negation_sentences.htm (Section: Exercise).



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